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02 September 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Shipping Paralegal role at the global law firm you are working with through Jameson Legal. My interest in ship finance and transactional shipping work has a specific starting point: at an A&O Shearman open day in August 2026 I attended a finance workshop that covered the security taken by lenders in major asset finance transactions, with examples drawn from aircraft and ship financing. That session made the commercial mechanics of asset-backed lending concrete for me, and I followed it up by completing a Coursera course on private equity covering fund structures, leverage and deal execution. This role sits squarely in the area I have been actively trying to understand.

My practical experience with transactional documents comes from my internship at Adobe, where I reviewed and amended software licensing agreements, assessed data-processing and confidentiality provisions, and communicated amendments to sales, legal and international business teams. Reviewing documentation for contractual risk, flagging provisions that needed legal input and reconciling commercial objectives with legal requirements were the daily shape of that work. Drafting finance transaction documents in a shipping context is a more specialised version of the same discipline, and I am confident I can apply that document-review and drafting foundation here.

At BCLP, across a year-long placement split between international arbitration and real estate disputes, I managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters simultaneously, maintained structured electronic case files in iManage, tracked procedural deadlines and coordinated directly with clients on required materials. Shortly before a significant arbitration deadline I became the only junior supporting the team, coordinating outstanding actions and helping ensure on-time submission. That experience of keeping multiple moving parts organised under time pressure is directly relevant to managing transactional files in a busy shipping practice.

What draws me to this particular role is the combination of high-value asset finance work and the transactional breadth, covering sale and purchase alongside ship building and refit projects, that means no two matters will follow exactly the same structure. Having built a foundation in document review and file management, and having developed a genuine interest in the finance side through the A&O Shearman event and the Coursera course, joining a specialist shipping team at a global firm is the logical next step for me.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva